

few rentals already, you probably have an idea of what's out there and for how much.

Don't forget to take the number of bedrooms into consideration too, as well as the location. Rentals fluctuate in price depending on quality, so be sure to compare similar apartments in similar neighborhoods.

If you're already renting a condo, room, or home, consider submitting a proposal to your landlord with your research findings. Hard stats will be the best negotiating tool you can offer. If they can't meet your request, have a thirty-day notice ready to submit, and be willing to go through with it. The landlord may decide that a vacancy is worse than lower rent and allow a decrease in payment, but use this tactic with caution. If you push too much below market value, you may find yourself out of a place to live!

2. SIGN AN EXTENDED LEASE

This doesn't work all the time, but if you plan to stick around for a while, try to negotiate a two or three-year lease for less. Speaking as a landlord myself, it's tough trying to find a reputable person to rent. I would much rather have a great tenant with an equally great credit score renting for longer at a lower price, than experience weeks and months of vacancy without pay.

If you are financially able, you could offer a certain number of payments in advance for a reduction in the monthly price. Many landlords are more than just one-time investors, and the extra cash would be a tempting incentive for those who have their eye on another property. They also love not having to worry about whether or not the rent will arrive on time.

3. RENT A DIFFERENT UNIT

Depending on the apartment complex, condominium, or multi-family home, there's a possibility that certain units cost more as a result of newer features, while others with older carpeting and dated cabinets rent for much less.